Shallow (<3,000 ft) Oil-and-Gas Drilling at and Within Ten Miles of the Caramba North Tract — Historical and Recent Record

Prepared: 2026-05-18 · **Subject site:** Caramba North tract (≈1,300 ac), Pecos County, TX — centroid ≈ 30.9032° N, 102.9747° W · **Classification:** Confidential

Purpose

This memorandum summarizes the historical and recent record of oil-and-gas drilling — with attention to shallow (<3,000 ft) wells — at and within ten miles of the Caramba North tract, drawn from the Railroad Commission of Texas (RRC) wellbore and drilling-permit records. It is provided as context for evaluating potential ground-vibration considerations for a data-center development on the site. Throughout, **new drilling (a new wellbore) is distinguished from recompletions (rework of an existing wellbore — no new hole drilled)**; only new drilling involves a drilling rig and the hydraulic-fracturing completion associated with ground vibration.

Proximity is reported at explicit distances from the tract centroid — principally **within two miles** and **within ten miles**. Ten miles is a deliberately generous boundary: ground vibration from drilling and completion attenuates well within that distance.

Summary of findings

No new drilling is occurring at or near the Caramba North site. Counting only genuine new wells (RRC "New Drill" permits, recompletions excluded): **no well of any kind has been spudded within two miles of the tract in over a decade**, **no new-drill well lies within five miles**, and only **three new-drill wells sit within ten miles** across all of 2020–2025 (nearest ≈ 6.9 miles; all three are deep ≥9,200 ft, spud 2020 and 2025). The only wells within two miles are old (1950s–2002), plugged, shallow vertical legacy wells — not active, not fracked, not a vibration source.

Two further points reinforce this:

- **The shallow activity in Pecos is recompletions, not new drilling.** Of permits filed in Pecos since 2020, about **45% are recompletions** — reworking existing wellbores, with no new hole drilled. A single operator, **Kinder Morgan Production, accounts for 96% of all recompletions** (reworking existing CO_2-flood fields). Recompletions use a workover rig on an existing bore; they are not the drilling-and-fracturing activity at issue, and this program is not near the site.
- **Genuine new drilling is deep, not shallow — and remote.** Pecos saw ≈478 New Drill permits since 2020 (vs ≈405 recompletion). Tracing those to wells actually spudded, only **116 genuine new wells** exist county-wide, and ≈**95% are deep (≥3,000 ft)** horizontal (Diamondback, XTO, Continental, Gordy); just **six** are shallow. New shallow drilling is

therefore nearly nonexistent anywhere in Pecos, and the deep new drilling that does occur is concentrated well away from the tract.

Findings

1. On the Caramba North tract

The shallowest wellbores recorded inside the tract boundary:

Depth (ft)	Spud year	Status	Oil/Gas
2,873	1960	Plugged & abandoned	Gas
3,067	1991	Plugged & abandoned	Oil
3,109	1957	Plugged & abandoned	Oil
3,186	1987	Plugged & abandoned	Oil
3,250	2008	Active	Oil

Only one well on the tract lies below 3,000 ft — a 2,873-ft well spudded in 1960 and long since plugged and abandoned. The only active well on the tract (3,250 ft, spudded 2008) is deeper than 3,000 ft. There has been no shallow (<3,000 ft) drilling on the tract in the modern era. *(The remaining tract records are a single deep 22,545-ft wellbore and permitted-but-undrilled location entries.)*

2. Within 1 mile — no shallow wells

Three wellbores of any depth lie within one mile of the tract; **none is shallow (<3,000 ft).**

3. Within 2 miles — drilling ended over two decades ago

Of about 46 wellbores within two miles, the ten shallow wells were spudded between 1960 and 2002. The most recent shallow spud within two miles was in 2002, and most of these wells are plugged and abandoned. **No well of any kind — new drill or otherwise — has been spudded within two miles in over a decade.**

4. New drilling since 2020, by distance

Counting only genuine new wells (RRC "New Drill" permits — recompletions of existing bores excluded):

Radius	New-drill wells, spudded ≥ 2020
≤ 2 mi	**0**
≤ 5 mi	**0**
≤ 10 mi	3 (0 shallow, 3 deep; nearest ≈ 6.9 mi)

The three genuine new wells within ten miles, across all of 2020–2025, are 6.9–9.4 miles out and all deep (≈9,200–9,500 ft; spudded 2020 and 2025) — none shallow, none within five miles. Even on the *loosest* possible count — every record with a 2020-or-later spud date, including recompletion-restamped records — it is still **zero within two miles** and only ≈23 within ten miles across the whole period. New drilling does not reach the site under any reading of the data.

5. The nearest active wells are decades-old completions

The nearest non-plugged shallow wells were spudded in 1970 (1.28 mi) and 1988 (1.97 mi) — decades-old completions, not active drilling. A ground-vibration source is an operating drill rig or a hydraulic-fracturing operation; a plugged or long-completed wellbore is not. No active drilling is occurring adjacent to the tract.

6. County-wide context — new drilling is deep, and remote from the site

Since 2020 the RRC issued roughly **478 New Drill permits** in Pecos County (≈4,700 sq mi), against **≈405 recompletion permits**. Tracing the New Drill permits to wells actually spudded gives **116 genuine new wells county-wide**, about **95% of them deep (≥3,000 ft)** — i.e., the modern Permian horizontal program. Only **three** lie within ten miles of the Caramba North tract, and none within five; the activity is overwhelmingly remote from the site.

7. The shallow activity in Pecos is recompletions of existing wells — not new drilling

This is the crux of the data. Permit filings in Pecos since 2020 split roughly **53% New Drill / 45% Recompletion**:

Activity (Pecos permits, since 2020)	Count	Character
New Drill	≈478	≈95% deep (≥3,000 ft) horizontal — new wellbores
Recompletion	**≈405**	**rework of existing wellbores — no new hole**

96% of every recompletion is one operator — Kinder Morgan Production — reworking existing CO_2-flood fields. The genuine *new-drill* operators are a different, all-deep set: Diamondback (≈30% of new drills), XTO (≈14%), Continental (≈13%), Gordy (≈11%), each essentially 100% deep.

The significance for ground vibration: a recompletion is a workover on an *existing* bore — no rig drilling a new hole, no new hydraulic-fracturing program of the kind associated with vibration. The large "shallow" footprint in Pecos is this rework activity, not drilling. Genuine new drilling is the deep-horizontal minority, and — per Findings 1–6 — essentially none of it is near the Caramba North tract. Whether the question is framed as shallow drilling, fracking, or new drilling of any kind, the record points the same way: it is not happening at or near this site.

8. Pecos vs. peer counties — the least new drilling of the group

On the same genuine-new-drill basis (recompletions excluded), Pecos has dramatically less new drilling than comparable Permian counties. Wells spudded since 2020:

County	New-drill wells since 2020	of which shallow (<3,000 ft)
Pecos (site county)	**116**	**6**

Reeves	1,044	35
Ward	396	7
Midland	1,487	15
Martin	1,616	19
Reagan	629	9
Other-5 average	**1,034**	**17**

Pecos's ≈116 genuine new wells are roughly **one-ninth of the average comparable county's** (≈1,034); Martin, the most active, has ≈1,616. Genuine new shallow drilling is negligible in every county (≤35). On a new-drill basis Pecos is the least-drilled of the six — and, per Findings 1–6, essentially none of even that activity is within ten miles of the Caramba North tract.

Howard and Loving counties were requested for comparison; they lie outside the six-county Permian extent of the Railroad Commission dataset used here, and their wellbore records are not in this dataset. A comparable new-drill figure for those counties requires a separate RRC pull and can be added on request.